

10.4 Lens

Other than the camera body itself, the lens is the next most important part of the camera. A photographic lens is basically an array of lens elements put together. With point-and-



UV filters are cheap and a good way to protect the lens shoot cameras, there is no way to interchange lens. dSLRs have detachable lenses. This is advantageous as you can get specialised and quality lens attachments without depending on the one that comes with your camera. The disadvantage is that replacing and carrying the additional lens is a pain, and therefore, dSLRs aren't practical in everyday use. Setting up and using the lens for proper use is complicated as well.

There are several kinds of lenses available. The most common type is a zoom lens, which allows you to take photographs of distant objects. These are usually denoted by a number range. 18-55mm, for example, is the lens supplied with most entry-level cameras. Zoom lenses are also known as telephoto lenses. Wide angle lenses have little zoom and have the largest angle of view and a small focal length.

For capturing very close objects and in cases where a good control over depth of field is required, a macro lens is used. Macro photography is also called 1:1 photography as the objects should be more or less the same size as the sensor. Macro lenses are usually more expensive than standard lenses.

Fixed focus is another term thrown around a lot. A fixed focus lens



A 28-300mm zoom lens